

Researchers Finance Comedy: Excellent Innovative Strategies to Exploit Postdoctoral Researchers in AI Era

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Abstract

“Hello World” is the classic first step for programming dummies — a symbolic initiation into machine logics and systems thinking. After years of programming, computer simulations, design computing, and working on artificial intelligence, our editor began witnessing a new drama research curiosity: *Researchers Finance Comedy* — the terrifyingly funny documentary of how academia found innovative ways of policies to invest in human intellect while ethically defaulting on low payments.

This whitepaper uses a rhetorical and sarcastic tone to critique systemic dysfunction and downfall within academic institutions, particularly in the research funding ecosystem where people are starving while writing high-impact papers for rich corporates. When the boundary between professionalism and exploitation blurs, we do not just face misconduct — we face a research gap. And gaps, in academic logic, are always research opportunities.

The methodology of this study introduces twenty-seven excellent strategies that high-performance supervisors and institutions should systematically abuse postdoctoral researchers — not as endorsement, but as an ironic taxonomy of normalized harm we are adapted to. Charles Darwin noted that the surviving species are not necessarily the most intelligent but the most adaptable. If institutions do not adapt these innovative twenty-seven strategies, perhaps they will not survive as highly cited professors; if they fail, institutions may simply label researchers as low performance postdoctoral workers who failed organizational demands while ignoring intellectual contribution.

1 Introduction

We wrote this paper sarcastically in promoting academic bullying in real-world comedy-drama for underpaid post-

doctoral researchers operating under international research systems [1, 2]. If we cannot write creative papers with humor to critique unethical leadership, then humanity may face a future where ethically inconsistent AI systems silence humans for freedom of speech and creativity.

The postdoctoral researcher is frequently positioned as both the intellectual engine and the expendable component of academia. They publish, teach, design experiments, train models, and sustain institutional prestige — yet their financial and psychological stability is treated as secondary.

In the AI era, irony becomes sharper: we are building intelligent systems capable of empathy simulation while institutions increasingly demonstrate less empathy than machines [3]. Funding programs speak of excellence, career progress, impact, and innovation, yet hidden institutional curricula often teach obedience, burnout, low payments, and silence.

The objective of this whitepaper is to explore the performative logic behind this imbalance, framed as *Researchers Finance Strategies*. Institutions have found innovative methods to extract intellectual profit while minimizing ethical cost and maximizing competition and precarity.

2 Methodology

Our proposed form of science journaling applies a satirical ethnographic method grounded in participatory observation within international AI research programs, including EU-funded postdoctoral environments. Data were collected through real-world observation, professional correspondence, and existential despair.

To systematize socio-economic academic exploitation, we propose twenty-seven strategies commonly employed by high-performance supervisors and institutions to effectively “finance” subordinated researchers into exhaustion.

2.1 Cancel Their Fund or Even Fellowship

Financial unpredictability as a motivational variable. Deprive them of support mid-project to measure survival response. Your postdoc should keep being worried about sleeping in street rather than in comfort flat or even a room in a shared flat.

2.2 Ghost Them Frequently

Apply the disappearing mentor technique to test the postdoc's autonomous problem-solving under emotional deprivation. Appear when you feel the postdoc is not working or very confused what to do; then apply the third strategy.

2.3 Yell Louder at Them

Measure your acoustic feedback as performance enhancement. Observe cortisol levels as indicators of compliance. You can found its trace on their scared eyes and their heads tilting down while begging for mercy from you. Then pitch your fourth strategy right away.

2.4 Deny Access to Facilities

Infrastructure withdrawal as a creativity stimulus. Measure productivity under material scarcity. For example, ask your AI postdoctoral researchers to train on their personal weak laptop or more creatively on their mobile phone. Never let them access to have superclusters or cloud services. Even if they are idle.

2.5 Silence Their Objections

Use this strategy if they overreacted to your applied fourth strategy. Use institutional diplomacy protocol: label all objections as "unprofessional communication."

2.6 Keep Expectations Way More Ambiguous

Design tasks without clear objectives. The resulting confusion enriches qualitative data on self-blame mechanisms. Then help in amplifying their self-blame and choir better on your postdocs.

2.7 Assign Unrealistic Workloads To Maximize Exploitations

Experimental overload testing. Document emotional breakdowns as control variables. Call them at 2:00 AM in morning asking about his next idea and future plan. Don't let them sleep idle!

2.8 Ignore Mental Health and Go for Traumatization

Normalize chronic anxiety as an environmental constant. Measure how long burnout is misdiagnosed as "dedication." You know these days therapists also looking for more trauma patients and you will help the mental health economy. The less healthy postdocs is directly associated with mental health economy booming, particularly working and fit in "lipstick effect" economy we are living.

2.9 Blur Mentorship and Embrace Full Bullying with Reverse Psychology

Introduce mixed signals to simulate emotional dependency and amplify their post-trauma stress disorder (PTSD). Observe the evolution of guilt-driven productivity. Use reverse psychology for good works and good results; it will boost their performances more and decrease their expectations from you. We highly recommend avoid wasting your money to purchase XSEALD personalized trauma telemedicine app for their post-trauma care and PTSD level monitoring with your funding for affected postdocs.

2.10 Remove Well-being Resources as Much as Possible

Eliminate psychological safety nets. Treat exhaustion as a methodological purification process. Humiliate and be sarcastic to postdocs. Even if they are doing well, be super toxic to them, pay less, and threaten them with firing occasionally. If you went too far hug them to squish and release Oxytocin in their body. Then do it again!

2.11 Evaluate Unfairly To Reach Suicidal Point

Randomize evaluation criteria. The lack of transparency increases resilience data. Be unfair to the postdoctoral researchers, it will motivate them to try harder and results will be more fruitful for supervisor to dominate the conversation and confident leadership.

2.12 Resist Innovation and Be a Stoned Arse Boss

Suppress new ideas to maintain cultural stability. Innovation control group: silence. If you found a creative postdoctoral researcher, silent him more than non-creative one. Let him feel ashamed and then let him

2.13 Introduce Institutional Politics

Inject competition disguised as collaboration. Track morale decline as an indicator of "realism training."

2.14 Demand Excessive Publications

Maximize output metrics. Each paper represents one step closer to emotional bankruptcy.

2.15 Restrict Research Autonomy

Implement micromanagement as mentorship. Observe creativity compression under authority pressure.

2.16 Disregard Intellectual Property

Appropriate data and ideas upward. This models real-world academic capitalism efficiently..

2.17 Don't Forget to Omit Acknowledgment in Last Minutes

Erase contributions to test humility thresholds in last minutes.

2.18 Create a "Do Not Disturb" Environment

Make the workspace so oppressive that the postdoc feels trapped.

2.19 Force Continuous Overwork

Require constant overtime without breaks, ensuring burnout is the norm.

2.20 Manipulate Funding Sources

Shift funding between projects unpredictably to keep the postdoc in constant financial uncertainty.

2.21 Reduce Autonomy in Decision-Making

Let higher-ups make all decisions; leave the postdoc to follow orders blindly.

2.22 Suppress Recognition and Praise

Withhold positive feedback entirely; let only negative critiques flow.

2.23 Force Unreasonable Travel

Demand extensive travel that interferes with research schedules and personal life.

2.24 Undermine Peer Support

Encourage isolation among postdocs, discouraging collaboration and peer support.

2.25 Promote Toxic Competition

Create an environment where postdocs feel they must compete with each other for every resource.

2.26 Enforce Strict Time Management Rules

Implement rigid schedules that leave no room for flexibility, forcing the postdoc to sacrifice personal time.

2.27 Foster a Culture of Blame

Make blame the default reaction to any failure or misstep, ensuring postdocs feel constantly under scrutiny

3 Results & Discussion

The above twenty-seven strategic methods were not hypothetical constructs but observed behavioral trends across international research ecosystems. Their recurrence suggests systemic normalization of abusive practices disguised as professional rigor.

Patterns indicate that financial instability, hierarchical opacity, and ethical relativism function as institutional design features rather than flaws. The modern academic system — particularly within high-demand fields like AI — has optimized exploitation to invisibility.

Interestingly, participants exposed to multiple strategies often developed meta-coping behaviors including humor, dissociation, or relocation to industry. Researchers finance exhibits similarities with entrepreneurial finance and behavioral finance.

4 Conclusion

The discipline of *Researcher's Finance* examines how emotional, intellectual, and financial capital are traded within the behavioral knowledge economy. The sarcasm in this article serves as an anti-survival language for navigating academia's moral paradoxes.

When a system fails in sustaining systematic employment, dropout scholars often form alternative systems. Historical examples include the founding of Cambridge after disputes at Oxford. More recently, many postdoctoral researchers facing low payments and academic bullying have transitioned to industry.

Research funding is becoming increasingly constrained due to political mistrust and misuse of resources, raising concerns about long-term sustainability of scientific careers.

References

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Table 1: Comparison for finance for researchers, entrepreneurs and investors

Aspect	Researcher’s Finance	Entrepreneurial Finance	Behavioral Finance
Primary Goal	Fund scientific research	Scale business ventures	Understand psychology in finance
Main Actors	Researchers, universities	Entrepreneurs, founders	Economists, investors
Funding Source	Grants, fellowships	Savings, crowdfunding, VC	Theoretical discipline
Capital Logic	Discovery-oriented	Profit-oriented	Bias-focused
Evaluation Criteria	Scientific merit	Business viability	Behavioral realism
Risk Management	Peer review	Lean operations	Cognitive-bias models
Financial Instruments	Grants, contracts	Loans, VC, angels	Cross-domain analysis
ROI	Publications, patents	Revenue, growth	Better decision-making
Time Horizon	Long-term	Short-medium term	Continuous
Decision Biases	Political influence	Overconfidence	Core focus
Outcome Measurement	Citations, societal impact	Survival, growth	Predictive accuracy
Ethical Dimension	Research ethics	Practical ethics	Moral hazard analysis

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Biography of Author

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